

THE SOCIAL UNIVERSE (TSU)

Continuity Bible — Master Canon Document

Purpose: This is the single source of truth for TSU canon. Every writer, every script, every "wait, did we already establish X" question gets answered here first. If it's not in this doc, it's not canon yet — propose it, don't assume it. This doc is the Kevin Feige's-office equivalent: nothing ships to a script until it's logged here.

Companion docs: TSU_Platform_Roster.md (fictional platforms) · TSU_Core_Cast.md (founding character bios)

1. THE SERIALIZATION MODEL

Ratio: 70% standalone / 30% serialized, matching the proven MCU structure.

- **The 70%:** Every platform-founding film must work as a complete, self-contained story for an audience who has seen *nothing* else in TSU. No film's core plot may depend on information withheld to a prior film.
 - **The 30%:** Reserved for recurring characters crossing platforms, the through-line antagonist forces (THE ENGINE, THE SWARM, THE LEAK, THE COPIES), fixed timeline anchor-events referenced across films, and stingers/easter eggs seeding future Phases.
 - **Rule of thumb for any new scene:** if removing it would make a *different* film confusing, it's part of the 30% and must be logged in this doc's Cross-Film Threads section before the film locks picture. If removing it only affects the film it's in, it's part of the 70% and doesn't need cross-checking.
-

2. FORMAT & HOUSE STYLE

Binding specs for every TSU script. A script that deviates from these numbers needs a sign-off logged in §8, same as any other locked fact.

Genre & Subgenre

Primary genre: **Biographical Drama / Tech Origin Story** — the spine of the whole universe, playing the same structural role "superhero action" plays for the MCU. This is what "100% faithful to source material" actually means in practice: dramatizing real founding myths (fictionalized), not inventing fantasy.

Subgenres layer per-Phase, the way MCU shifts tone film to film, rather than applying uniformly to every entry: - **Corporate thriller** — founder disputes, betrayals, acquisitions (THE ROSTER's origin, the Phase 2 "Quiet Acquisition") - **Underdog sports-movie structure** — borrowed shape (not genre) for Phase 1 founding arcs: scrappy outsider builds something from nothing, takes on giants - **Ensemble dramedy** — the found-family/relationship material (weddings, godparent-hood, group dynamics) that can't live inside corporate-thriller tension alone - **Satire, dialed carefully** — reserved specifically for THE SWARM and

THE ENGINE storylines; TSU's comic-relief valve, same job Ant-Man/Guardians plays tonally inside a heavier universe - **Legal/courtroom drama** — recurring beat for THE LEAK scandals and founder-dispute litigation, same way MCU periodically drops into "Congressional hearing" mode

Rating

PG-13 across the entire universe. No exceptions, no R-rated entries, no PG entries. This is a commercial mechanism, not just a tone choice — PG-13 is the only rating that plays to teens, parents, and adults simultaneously, which is the actual revenue engine of a tentpole franchise. It's also the only rating built to handle betrayal, addiction-adjacent tech-culture critique, and corporate ruthlessness honestly without capping the audience or killing merchandising.

Runtime

Entry Type	Runtime
Standard platform-origin film	130–150 minutes
Phase finale / ensemble crossover	150–180 minutes

Script Page Count (*Industry standard: 1 page is about 1 minute of screen time*)

Entry Type	Page Count
Standard platform-origin film	120–140 pages
Phase finale / ensemble crossover	150–170 pages (hard ceiling — scripts that balloon past this cut in the edit anyway; write tight rather than shoot pages you'll lose)

Act Structure

Three acts, always. - **Act I** — ~25% of runtime (~30–35 pages): ordinary world, inciting incident (the spark for the platform), ends on the decision to build it - **Act II** — ~50% (~65–75 pages): the build, the complications, relationship strain, midpoint escalation (usually a rival platform or a betrayal), ends on the low point / all-is-lost beat - **Act III** — ~25% (~30–35 pages): climax (usually the platform's public launch or direct confrontation with a rival/villain force), resolution, stinger

Scene Count

Entry Type	Scene Count
Standard platform-origin film	~40–55 scenes
Phase finale / ensemble crossover	~55–70 scenes (larger ensemble needs more coverage)

3. FIXED TIMELINE ANCHORS

Dates and events every film must treat as immovable fact. Individual films may show these events from a new angle but may never contradict them.

Anchor Event	Date	What It Locks
THE LEDGER founded	1997	Phase 0 opens
HOMESTEAD shutdown ("The First Erasure")	2001	TSU's first mass-casualty event — referenced as cultural trauma in later Phases
THE FIRST CIRCLE launches	2002	Phase 1 begins
TOP8 launches	2003	—
THE BOARDROOM launches	2003	—
THE ROSTER launches	Feb 2004	Founding-four complete
Phase 1 Finale — "The Feed War"	2004–2005	THE ROSTER absorbs/outlasts TOP8. First platform-vs-platform casualty event. Opening act dramatized in <code>scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md</code> ; TOP8's full wind-down happens off-screen in the intervening years, referenced (not dramatized) in <code>scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md</code> .
THE PROJECTOR launches	2005	Phase 2 begins
THE HIVE launches	2005	Flavor-only real-world reference year; no founder was attached until <code>scripts/THE_HIVE.md</code> locked its actual in-story founding over a decade later (Oct 2017 – May 2018), deliberately bridging Story Phase 3 into Story Phase 4 — the same divergence principle already established for THE EMBER in <code>scripts/THE_EMBER.md</code> .
THE WIRE launches	2006	—
THE GALLERY launches	2007	—
THE FRAME launches	2010	Phase 2 closes

Anchor Event	Date	What It Locks
Phase 2 Finale — "The Quiet Acquisition"	2010–2012	THE ROSTER acquires THE FRAME. Dramatized in <code>scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md</code> (2011) as a fair deal on Arianna Cummings's own terms — the anchor is honored corporately, reframed emotionally as redemption for Film 1's freeze-out rather than a repeat of it.
THE WHISPER NETWORK launches	2009	Phase 3 begins (chronological overlap w/ Phase 2 is intentional — see §5). Founded solo by Naomi Adeyemi-Vance (new character); the founding dramatized in flashback within <code>scripts/THE_WHISPER_NETWORK.md</code> , whose main story is set 2021. Platform self-shuts-down at that film's close rather than continue operating a government-compliance backdoor.
THE ATLAS launches	2010	Founded solo by Imani Osei-Katz (new character); the founding dramatized in flashback within <code>scripts/THE_ATLAS.md</code> , whose main story is set 2021.
THE EMBER launches	2011	—
THE FLICKER launches	2013	—
"The Flicker Goes Dark"	2016	THE FLICKER shuts down. TSU's mass-mourning event. Diaspora subplot begins.
THE OUTPOST launches	2015	Phase 3 closes

Anchor Event	Date	What It Locks
The Founders' Oversight Accord ratified	2017	Government-mandated registration for any cross-platform safety tool or founder-run oversight body, passed by a majority of the industry's major boards in the wake of GENESIS. THE ROSTER and THE WIRE sign; THE FRAME operates outside it by Arianna Cummings's choice. Dramatized in <code>scripts/THE_FRAME_3.md</code> — the first standing institutional split in the franchise's history, still open when Release Phase 3 continues.
THE ORACLE launches	2018	Phase 4 begins
THE MIRROR launches	2020	—
THE PLEDGE launches	2021	New platform (Patreon analog), founded solo by Jasmine Torres — dissolves deliberately into creator-owned cooperatives by its own film's close; see <code>scripts/THE_PLEDGE.md</code> .
THE ECHO launches	2023	—
SIGNAL-0 (THE WIRE reborn)	2023	Phase 4 current state

Standing rule: no future script may move a launch date without a change-request logged in §8 and approved before the page is written. A launch date is load-bearing — other films' timelines are built off it.

4. CHARACTER LOCATION / STATUS TRACKER

Where each founding cast member is, professionally, at the start and end of each Phase. Update this table the moment any film changes a character's status — this is the most common source of continuity errors in ensemble franchises (an actor's film shoots out of release order, and a character's status quo gets contradicted by accident).

Character	Status, Start of Phase 1 (2002)	Status, End of Phase 1 (2004–05)	Notes
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Working actor/singer, pre-adult-breakout	Founder/CEO, THE ROSTER; survived the Feed War's opening attack, a managed arrhythmia, and a public reckoning with Solomon Kane's claim against Victor Donohue	Locked per scripts/THE_ROSTER.md and scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md. Public triumph, personal cost — closes Phase 1 estranged from Amond, leaning on Esther and Tyrese instead
Amond Baker	Typecast, cooling career	Co-founder, THE ROSTER — diluted out via cap-table restructure; estranged from Marc-Anthony	Locked per scripts/THE_ROSTER.md. This wound is the direct inciting wound for his own founding story, Film 2/Phase 2 (see §9)
Tyrese Avery	Established global pop superstar	Founder, THE PROJECTOR (launched, then lost, then rebuilt smaller in Dec 2005)	Locked per scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md. New relationship (Dr. Simone Kester) originates here — first romantic arc for this character
Esther Smilley	Award-winning actress, fighting "sweetheart" typecasting	<i>(platform assignment pending)</i>	Not yet romantically involved w/ Marc-Anthony — that doesn't begin until 2011, no film may imply earlier
Arianna Cummings	Three professional near-misses, no breakthrough	Founder, THE FRAME (launched Oct 25, 2010, from a hospital waiting room during her brother's recovery)	Locked per scripts/THE_FRAME.md. New relationship (Malcolm Pierce) originates here
Harmony Divine	Dancer transitioning to acting	<i>(platform assignment pending)</i>	Not yet romantically involved w/ Amond — begins 2013
Tyler Chapman	Steady "and also starring" work, capped ceiling	<i>(platform assignment pending)</i>	Secret music ambition is a Chekhov's gun — a later Phase should pay it off

Locked romantic timeline (do not contradict in any script, flashback, or flash-forward): - Marc-Anthony & Esther: friends throughout Phase 1–2, together 2011, married June 2013 (dramatized in scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_2.md) - Amond & Harmony: circling throughout Phase 1–3, together June

2013 at the above wedding (dramatized in [scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_2.md](#)), married 2015 - Emma & Victoria Bullock born May 10, 2012 (twins) - Lyric Baker born April 20, 2014; Marc-Anthony is godfather

Status after Film 6 ([scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md](#), closing Nov 2011) — a second checkpoint, since the table above only tracks through in-universe Phase 1 (2004–05) and the release-slot slate runs well past that:

Character	Status, end of THE ASSEMBLY (2011)
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Founder/CEO, THE ROSTER; refused a hostile acquisition of THE FRAME and negotiated a fair one instead; reconciling with Amond, not yet fully; together with Esther as of this film, per the locked date
Amond Baker	Founder/CEO, THE WIRE; the one who spotted Teddy's pattern first and warned Arianna; reconciling with Marc-Anthony, not yet fully — deliberately unresolved
Tyrese Avery	Founder, THE PROJECTOR, now fully stable under Jamal Kester's product leadership; with Dr. Simone Kester
Esther Smilley	Effectively running much of THE ROSTER's day-to-day operations; together with Marc-Anthony as of this film
Arianna Cummings	THE FRAME acquired by THE ROSTER on her own terms — full creative control retained, her name still on the door; with Malcolm Pierce
Harmony Divine	Still circling Amond, deliberately unresolved per the locked 2013 date
Tyler Chapman	Unassigned, unresolved — secret music ambition still an open Chekhov's gun for a future Phase (resolved as of the post-Film-11 checkpoint below)

Status after Film 7 ([scripts/THE_ROSTER_3.md](#), closing May 10, 2012):

Character	Status, end of THE ROSTER 3 (May 2012)
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Chairman and CEO, THE ROSTER — unchanged, not up for negotiation in this film; arrhythmia finally under real treatment; survived THE UNSEEN crisis by delegating rather than solving it alone; father to Emma and Victoria as of this film's final scene

Character	Status, end of THE ROSTER 3 (May 2012)
Esther Smilley	Named President of THE ROSTER (day-to-day operations), formally, in this film's final scene — the role made official, not new, and not a change to Marc-Anthony's title; publicly dismantled Desmond Okafor-Lindqvist's synthetic-media operation herself; mother to Emma and Victoria
Amond Baker	Founder/CEO, THE WIRE; caught Marc-Anthony's second collapse before anyone else did; reconciliation with Marc-Anthony now genuinely warm, if still imperfect
Tyrese Avery / Arianna Cummings	Both platforms' engineering teams co-built THE ROSTER's proof-of-origin countermeasure — the ensemble's first fully coordinated technical collaboration across companies
Desmond Okafor-Lindqvist	Exposed and in legal proceedings via Constance Abiodun-Mayhew; settlement includes public patent credit rather than just consulting fees

Status after Film 8 (scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_2.md, closing Aug 2013):

Character	Status, end of THE PROJECTOR 2 (Aug 2013)
Tyrese Avery	Declined the Family-Safe Content Consortium chair; stays at THE PROJECTOR on his own terms; his mother Coralee Avery died July 2013 (see TSU_Family_Bible.md); new family-content guidelines launched in her memory
Marc-Anthony Bullock & Esther Smilley	Married June 2013 — the locked date, finally dramatized
Amond Baker & Harmony Divine	Together as of June 2013, at the above wedding — the locked date, finally dramatized; married 2015 still to come
Marcus Nguyen-Brandt	Genuinely helped Tyrese at real cost to his usual practice; quietly absorbed a significant, unacknowledged share of Vernon Price's collapsed operation in the process — a thread left open, not resolved
Vernon Price / Maxwell Sterling Asante	THE LULLABY exposed and collapsed; Maxwell already chasing the next pitch

Status after Film 9 (scripts/THE_FRAME_2.md, closing June 2014):

Character	Status, end of THE FRAME 2 (June 2014)
Arianna Cummings & Marc-Anthony Bullock	Co-exposed THE VERDICT and Evelyn Marchetti-Hale; first film where the two lead as genuine equals rather than one supporting the other
Priya Ramasubramanian	Alive the entire film — faked the severity of a near-fatal accident with Constance Abiodun-Mayhew's help to investigate Evelyn from hiding; revealed publicly at the climax; already tracking international regulatory names (Chioma Asante-Reyes) by the stinger
Evelyn Marchetti-Hale	Removed from every board she sat on; referred to Senator Ashworth-Okafor's committee
Benji Oyelaran-Cox	Not prosecuted; publicly credited for coming forward; cautiously welcomed back into the ensemble's orbit
All platforms Evelyn touched (THE ROSTER, THE FRAME, others)	Committed publicly to independent oversight and a real appeals process

Status after Film 10 (scripts/THE_OUTPOST.md, closing June 2015):

Character	Status, end of THE OUTPOST (June 2015)
Kwame "K-Dot" Ashford-Petrov, Benji Oyelaran-Cox, Sister Rosalind Okonjo, Felicity Drummond-Asante	THE OUTPOST launched and incorporated — the franchise's first founding team with no core-seven member on it; all four fully activated as leads for the first time
Benji Oyelaran-Cox	Building something small, private, and entirely their own for the first time, rather than someone else's weapon — the direct throughline from their Film 9 rehabilitation
Desiree Holloway / THE SWARM	Abundance Summit pyramid scheme publicly exposed and collapsed; already testing a rebrand ("LUMINOUS") by the closing stinger, per THE SWARM's bible rule that it's never fully defeated, only rebranded
The core seven	Off-screen this film by design; THE OUTPOST is deliberately the franchise's first fully self-contained founding story since Film 1

Status after Film 11 (scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_2.md, closing April 2016):

Character	Status, end of THE ASSEMBLY 2 (April 2016)
Marc-Anthony Bullock & Amond Baker	Publicly accountable for building GENESIS; testified unprompted before Senator Ashworth-Okafor's committee that it was a joint decision, not a single founder's error
Marc-Anthony Bullock & Arianna Cummings	First real, unresolved ideological rift in the ensemble — centralized safety vs. creator autonomy — deliberately left open past this film
Tyler Chapman	Secret Georgia recording studio and years of unheard music revealed to the group; resolves the "open Chekhov's gun" flagged after Film 6, though a music-career pivot is still not yet dramatized
Marcus Nguyen-Brandt	Arc closed — chose honesty over a shortcut for the first time in his bible entry; founding member of the new Founders' Compact
Naledi Ferreira-Osei	Defected from GENESIS; surviving twin; founding member of the Founders' Compact
Kwabena Ferreira-Osei	Died in the climax shielding bystanders from a GENESIS-triggered infrastructure failure — the franchise's highest human cost to date, permanent, not undone
The Founders' Compact (new)	Chartered: Marc-Anthony Bullock, Arianna Cummings, Priya Ramasubramanian, Marcus Nguyen-Brandt, Naledi Ferreira-Osei — five people with written override power, deliberately smaller and slower than GENESIS

Status after Film 12 (scripts/THE_EMBER.md, closing Dec 2016 — end of Release Phase 2):

Character	Status, end of THE EMBER (Dec 2016)
Tyler Chapman	Founder, THE EMBER — the franchise's last core-seven platform assignment, resolved deliberately last; finally seen by the group as a peer founder rather than the group's reliable glue
August Weathersby-Okonjo	Advised THE EMBER's build; refused any credit or title, consistent with his entire bible entry
Darius "Dez" Okonkwo-Fairweather / VAPOR	Exposed via Jules Abernathy-Kim's reporting; not defeated, already pitching a smaller comeback round
Marc-Anthony Bullock & Amond Baker	Confronted, for the first time, what twelve films of treating Tyler as "reliable" actually cost him

Character	Status, end of THE EMBER (Dec 2016)
Marc-Anthony Bullock & Arianna Cummings	Still unreconciled from <code>scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_2.md</code> ; named on opposite sides of a new regulatory proposal in this film's stinger

Release Phase 2 closes here (Films 7–12).

Status after Film 13 (`scripts/THE_FRAME_3.md`, closing Sept 2017 — opens Release Phase 3):

Character	Status, end of THE FRAME 3 (Sept 2017)
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Signed the Accord; privately shattered by Solange's revelation about GENESIS's cut fail-safe, told no one yet
Arianna Cummings	Refused to sign; THE FRAME now operates outside the Founders' Oversight Accord, a standing institutional choice
Amond Baker	Seriously injured (crushed leg, will walk again) during the summit standoff — caused by the founders' own internal fracture, not by any villain
Naledi Ferreira-Osei	Signed the Accord for reasons entirely her own; talked Solange into surrendering without ever defending the Accord to her
Benji Oyelaran-Cox	Cleared of the frame-up; stepped back from public-facing work, quietly protected at THE OUTPOST
Solange Achebe-Marsh	In custody; Naledi visiting her voluntarily, unresolved whether real mercy follows
The Founders' Compact	Fractured in practice, not dissolved — Marc-Anthony and Naledi on one side of the Accord question, Arianna, Tyler, and Marcus on the other
Founders' Oversight Accord	Ratified by a majority of the industry's major boards; THE FRAME the one major holdout

Status after Film 14 (`scripts/THE_HIVE.md`, closing May 2018 — Story Phase 4 begins):

Character	Status, end of THE HIVE (May 2018)
Dr. Malachi Osunwole-Grant	Founder, THE HIVE — hands permanently changed, launches the platform deliberately self-governing, structured against his own total control

Character	Status, end of THE HIVE (May 2018)
Odalys "Oz" Whitfield-Nkemelu	Died protecting THE HIVE's oldest architecture through the containment loop's final push; the network held
Dr. Femi Okonkwo-Larsen / THE RECKONING	Deployment contained via rollback loop; not defeated in a confrontation, simply exhausted into giving up
Thad Okonkwo-Larsen	Disillusioned by everyone; walked away from the ensemble entirely, unresolved
Priya Ramasubramanian	First investment in the franchise explicitly structured against her own future control of what she funds
Dr. Adaeze Okonkwo-Brennan	Cameo only, by design; cross-Phase recurring role preserved for future films

Status after Film 15 (scripts/THE_OUTPOST_2.md, closing Aug 2021):

Character	Status, end of THE OUTPOST 2 (Aug 2021)
Kwame Ashford-Petrov, Benji Oyelaran-Cox, Sister Rosalind Okonjo, Felicity Drummond-Asante	THE OUTPOST's decentralized "thousand nations" survive THE ORACLE's first coordinated siege by federating vulnerability data without centralizing control; published their own infrastructure's undisclosed government-compliance backdoor rather than hide it
Amond Baker, Arianna Cummings	Activated as real cross-platform allies for the first time since their own founding films
Cassius Wren	Single prison-visit scene; confirmed, without confessing to a chargeable act, that he has been shaping THE ORACLE's strategy from inside — the direct inciting engine for Film 19
THE ORACLE	Learns coordinated resistance is possible; begins calculating a multiplatform strategy rather than single-platform predation

Status after Film 16 (scripts/THE_WHISPER_NETWORK.md, closing May 2021):

Character	Status, end of THE WHISPER NETWORK (May 2021)
Naomi Adeyemi-Vance	Founder, THE WHISPER NETWORK; learns her own platform carried a six-year undisclosed government backdoor under an NSL gag order; chooses public disclosure and self-shutdown over continued compliance

Character	Status, end of THE WHISPER NETWORK (May 2021)
Maya Chen	New; the platform's discoverer, not its founder; loses her job, keeps her integrity; recurring going forward
James Hart	Corroborated the evidence from inside at real professional cost
Delphine Okonkwo-Ash	Backs the harder, less convenient truth again, consistent with her pattern since Films 5 and 14
THE WHISPER NETWORK	Shuts down permanently by its own founder's choice rather than continue operating compromised; users scatter to THE MIRROR and elsewhere

Status after Film 17 (scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_3.md, closing Nov 2021):

Character	Status, end of THE PROJECTOR 3 (Nov 2021)
Tyrese Avery	Loses legal control of THE PROJECTOR's original corporate infrastructure to an estranged half-sister, Celestine Avery-Ridgeway, backed by THE ORACLE capital; wins by migrating the creator community onto new infrastructure rather than fighting for the old company
Darius "Dez" Okonkwo-Fairweather	Reactivated from his scripts/THE_EMBER.md stinger; becomes a genuine ally rather than a rebranding threat
Jamal Kester, Dr. Simone Kester	Full load-bearing support through the migration
Celestine Avery-Ridgeway	New; wins the paperwork, left holding an empty shell once THE ORACLE loses interest

Status after Film 18 (scripts/THE_ATLAS.md, closing Nov 2021):

Character	Status, end of THE ATLAS (Nov 2021)
Imani Osei-Katz	Founder, THE ATLAS; reveals THE AESTHETIC NATION's existence publicly rather than stay hidden, defeating a regulatory "platform fairness" framework through public support
Amara Fontaine	New; THE ATLAS's reluctant public face; returns to private artistic practice after the reveal

Character	Status, end of THE ATLAS (Nov 2021)
THE ORACLE	First confirmed failure to model a platform's core value (aesthetic coherence); redirects its attention toward the ensemble stakes of Film 19

Status after Film 19 (scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_3.md, closing March 2022):

Character	Status, end of THE ASSEMBLY 3 (March 2022)
Cassius Wren	Proves, from prison, that ecosystem fragmentation was always exploitable at scale; a coordinated legal/financial strike freezes or severs roughly half of the ensemble's built infrastructure in a single day — no core cast member or load-bearing recurring character dies; the cost is institutional
Marc-Anthony Bullock	States the ensemble's founding-Phase-3 failure directly: "We kept building nations. He built one court order."
THE OUTPOST, THE HIVE, THE ATLAS, THE PROJECTOR	Federation severed, self-governance overridden, ranking protections gutted, and creator payouts frozen respectively — all reversible, none yet reversed
The ensemble	Its lowest, most humbled point in the franchise's history — apart, legally constrained, without an obvious next move

Status after Film 20 (scripts/THE_EMBER_2.md, closing July 2022):

Character	Status, end of THE EMBER 2 (July 2022)
Tyler Chapman	Formally names Zora Osei co-founder of THE EMBER
Zora Osei	Aged up to 22; elevated from TSU_Family_Bible.md's "narrative spark" framing to full co-founder engineer; builds the ephemeral-architecture loophole that becomes Film 22's toolkit
Sage Okonkwo-Delacroix	New; resolved through mercy (a legitimate expiration of her own permanent record) rather than defeat, consistent with the franchise's pattern for ideology-driven antagonists
August Weathersby-Okonjo	Mentor role cashed in a second time, exactly as his bible entry promised

Status after Film 21 (scripts/THE_PLEDGE.md, closing Dec 2021 — concurrent with Film 19's back half):

Character	Status, end of THE PLEDGE (Dec 2021)
Jasmine Torres	Founder, THE PLEDGE; deliberately dissolves the company into creator-owned cooperatives rather than fight THE ORACLE's financial warfare directly; becomes a protocol steward with no authority over anyone
Marcus	Trains non-technical creators to run their own cooperative instances; later consults directly on Film 22's THE PROJECTOR payout restructuring
Elena	Becomes a cooperative steward in her own right
Priya Ramasubramanian	Her investment-structured-against-own-control philosophy (<code>scripts/THE_HIVE.md</code>) reaches its most extreme expression yet

Status after Film 22 (`scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_4.md`, closing Dec 2022 — closes Release Phase 3):

Character	Status, end of THE ASSEMBLY 4 (Dec 2022)
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Delivers the Unification Vote's killing blow by voluntarily forfeiting THE ROSTER's controlling board seats across every joint venture Cassius's proposal targeted, live, on the record — this franchise's Endgame-slot sacrifice, institutional rather than fatal
Esther Smilley	Already aware of and supporting Marc-Anthony's forfeiture strategy before it's delivered publicly
Cassius Wren	Arc closes after four films (6, 19, 22, plus the planted thread in <code>scripts/THE_OUTPOST_2.md</code>); prison communications formally exposed as unlawful influence rather than protected counsel; sentence extended, access cut off
Delphine Okonkwo-Ash	Refuses Cassius's coercion attempt and preempts his leaked-history threat herself, on camera, turning his leverage into evidence against him
Tyler Chapman, Zora Osei	Their Film 20 loophole becomes the ensemble's literal restoration toolkit
THE OUTPOST, THE HIVE, THE ATLAS, THE PROJECTOR	All four restored to functional, independently governed status by the film's climax
THE ORACLE	Loses both Cassius as an instrument and the Unification Vote as a strategy; redirects toward a cheaper proxy target (Film 23's stinger)

Character	Status, end of THE ASSEMBLY 4 (Dec 2022)
Release Phase 3	Penultimate film; closes one film later at Film 23, matching the MCU's own eleven-film Phase 3 structure (Far From Home following Endgame)

Status after Film 23 (scripts/THE_WHISPER_NETWORK_2.md, closing March 2023 — Release Phase 3 epilogue):

Character	Status, end of THE WHISPER NETWORK 2 (March 2023)
Maya Chen	Wins the technical fight against a fraudulent WHISPER NETWORK revival but is permanently, publicly unmasked — can no longer operate anonymously going forward
Damien Voss	New; convicted of fraud; a "sincere con man" who genuinely believed his fabrications were justified
James Hart	Publicly implicated by association; chooses to stand with Maya rather than distance himself
THE ORACLE	Confirmed as Voss's indirect financier via Meridian Sightlines LLC, a second instance of its proxy-financing strategy; escapes formal consequence via laundered corporate structure
Khaya Adeleke / THE MIRROR	Offers Maya a deliberately public-facing security role, which she accepts on her own terms
Release Phase 3	Closes here (Films 13–23), an eleven-film slate matching the MCU's own Phase 3 structure exactly

5. THE VILLAINS BENCH — RULES OF ENGAGEMENT

Because THE ENGINE, THE LEAK, THE SWARM, and THE COPIES are forces rather than single actors/characters, they need usage rules so they don't become a crutch:

- **THE ENGINE** may appear inside any platform's internal story, but must manifest differently each time (it's not one villain wearing different masks — it's a recurring *idea*, re-cast in tone and visual language per platform). THE ENGINE inside THE ROSTER should not look or feel like THE ENGINE inside THE ORACLE.
- **THE LEAK** is a one-per-Phase maximum event. Overusing it flattens its impact — it should land like a real scandal, not a plot device you can pull twice a Phase.
- **THE SWARM** is the only bench villain allowed genuine comic relief — a trickster figure that should never be played as a pure threat.

- **THE COPIES** exist to signal a platform's decline is coming, never to be the actual reason a platform falls. The real cause of any platform's fall must always trace back to a character decision, per the "faithful to source material" mandate — these platforms died from human choices (acquisitions, mismanagement, neglect), not from an abstract force acting alone.

6. KNOWN TIMELINE OVERLAP (INTENTIONAL, NOT AN ERROR)

Phases are organized thematically, not strictly chronologically — same approach MCU uses (Captain Marvel is set in the 90s but released in Phase 3). THE WHISPER NETWORK (2009) launches before THE FRAME (2010) closes out Phase 2. This is intentional: Phase boundaries mark thematic shifts (Media Wars -> Mobile Saga), not hard calendar cutoffs. Any writer confused by an out-of-phase date should check this section before "fixing" it.

7. OPEN CONTINUITY QUESTIONS

(Must be resolved before Phase 1 scripts lock)

1. **Platform assignments** — which founder gets which platform. Nothing in §3 can be finalized until this is settled.

Locked constraint (user directive): the core seven are founders of the major platforms that are **still popular and around to this day** — i.e., surviving/thriving platforms as of present day, not defunct ones. This rules out assigning any of the core seven as founders of platforms already marked dead on the Platform Roster (THE LEDGER, ROLL CALL, DEAR DIARY, HOMESTEAD, THE FIRST CIRCLE, TOP8, THE FLICKER) — those stay populated by Rivals/Extended Ensemble characters instead. Which specific surviving platforms (candidates per the Roster: THE ROSTER, THE PROJECTOR, THE FRAME, THE HIVE, THE WIRE/SIGNAL-0, THE ORACLE, THE OUTPOST, THE WHISPER NETWORK, THE BOARDROOM, THE ATLAS, THE EMBER) map to which of the seven is **explicitly not decided yet** — do not assign in any script or scene until this is resolved and logged here.

Resolved so far: - **THE ROSTER -> Marc-Anthony Bullock** (founder) + **Amond Baker** (co-founder, diluted out). Locked per `scripts/THE_ROSTER.md`, Film 1 ("Iron Man" slot). - **THE WIRE -> Amond Baker** (sole founder, post-ROSTER). Locked as of this entry, Film 2 ("Incredible Hulk" slot) — see §9. Script not yet written. - **THE BOARDROOM -> no core-seven founder**. Per `scripts/THE_ROSTER.md` scene 13, it's already a mature "old guard" institution before Phase 1's story begins. It stays that way unless a future pass decides otherwise. - **THE PROJECTOR -> Tyrese Avery** (sole founder). Locked, Film 4 ("Thor" release slot) — see §9. Script: `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md`. - **THE FRAME -> Arianna Cummings** (sole founder). Locked, Film 5 ("Captain America: The First Avenger" release slot) — see §9. Script: `scripts/THE_FRAME.md`. The reservation flagged when THE PROJECTOR was locked has now been claimed correctly, not spent on a different film. - **THE OUTPOST -> Kwame "K-Dot" Ashford-Petrov, Benji Oyelaran-Cox, Sister Rosalind Okonjo, and Felicity Drummond-Asante** (founding team, no core-seven member). Locked, Film 10 ("Guardians of the Galaxy" release slot) — see §9. Script: `scripts/THE_OUTPOST.md`. - **THE EMBER -> Tyler Chapman** (sole founder), the franchise's last core-seven assignment, deliberately closing the question this list opened back in Film 1. Locked, Film

12 ("Ant-Man" release slot, closing Release Phase 2) — see §9. Script: `scripts/THE_EMBER.md`. - **THE HIVE** -> **Dr. Malachi Osunwole-Grant** (sole founder, new character, not core-seven). Locked, Film 14 ("Doctor Strange" release slot) — see §9. Script: `scripts/THE_HIVE.md`. - **THE WHISPER NETWORK** -> **Naomi Adeyemi-Vance** (sole founder, new character, not core-seven). Locked, Film 16 ("Spider-Man: Homecoming" release slot) — see §9. Script: `scripts/THE_WHISPER_NETWORK.md`. - **THE ATLAS** -> **Imani Osei-Katz** (sole founder, new character, not core-seven). Locked, Film 18 ("Black Panther" release slot) — see §9. Script: `scripts/THE_ATLAS.md`. - **THE PLEDGE (new platform, Patreon analog)** -> **Jasmine Torres** (sole founder, new character, not core-seven). Locked, Film 21 ("Captain Marvel" release slot) — see §9. Script: `scripts/THE_PLEDGE.md`. Not part of the original Roster's surviving-platform list; added directly to `TSU_Platform_Roster.md`'s Phase 4 table. - **Q1 now fully resolved**: every surviving platform on the original Roster has a locked founder. Esther Smiley, Harmony Divine remain the only core-seven members without a platform of their own — confirmed by design; both remain load-bearing operators/supporting founders across the ensemble instead. THE ORACLE remains locked as a Phase 4 antagonist, not available as a hero platform. 2. Does Marc-Anthony's dynasty family (Natasha, Robert, Victor, Joan) have their own platform ties, or do they stay industry-only and never cross into TSU's tech side? 3. Is Tyrese's "outside perspective" going to culminate in him founding a platform himself (likely music/audio-coded, e.g. a Clubhouse-style entry in Phase 4), or does he stay permanently adjacent as a non-founder? 4. Does Tyler's music ambition get its own founding story later, or does it stay a personal subplot inside whichever platform story he's attached to? 5. Confirm whether the "lost a role to follower count" beat for Arianna is meant to happen at a specific, nameable point on the timeline (needs a year) so it can be logged as an anchor event.

8. CHANGE LOG

(Every edit to a locked fact gets logged here, with date and reason — never silently overwrite an established fact)

Date	Change	Reason
—	Doc created	Baseline canon established from Platform Roster + Core Cast docs
—	Added §2 Format & House Style (genre, rating, runtime, page count, act/scene structure); renumbered §3–§8	Locked universal format specs so all future scripts conform
2026-09-17	Added platform-assignment constraint to §7 Q1: the core seven must be founders of platforms still popular/surviving today, not defunct ones. Specific mapping still undecided.	User directive — narrows the open question without resolving it

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-17	Locked Film 1 (THE ROSTER, Marc-Anthony + Amond) and Film 2 (THE WIRE, Amond solo) in §7 Q1 and new §9. Updated §4 tracker for Marc-Anthony and Amond accordingly. Confirmed THE BOARDROOM has no core-seven founder.	Script written for Film 1 (scripts/THE_ROSTER.md); Film 2 platform selected per user request, filling the "Incredible Hulk" release slot
2026-09-17	Standing rule added: a "what's the perfect platform" question is now always a cue to write the full script, not just select the platform. Locked Film 2's script (scripts/THE_WIRE.md).	User directive
2026-09-17	Locked Film 3: THE ROSTER 2 ("Iron Man 2" slot), dramatizing the Feed War's opening act. Added Eldridge Kane, Solomon Kane, and Carter Westbrook to TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md and TSU_Historical_Context.md §5. Updated §4 tracker for Marc-Anthony.	Script written per user request (scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md)
2026-09-18	Split the Donohue Estate from the Bullock Estate as separate residences; fixed three Victor's-study sluglines in scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md accordingly.	User correction
2026-09-18	Locked Film 4: THE PROJECTOR ("Thor" slot), founded by Tyrese Avery. Added Jamal Kester and Dr. Simone Kester to TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md. Flagged THE FRAME as reserved for the eventual "Captain America" slot rather than assigning it casually. Updated §4 tracker for Tyrese.	Script written per user request (scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md)

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 5: THE FRAME ("Captain America: The First Avenger" slot), founded by Arianna Cummings, claiming the reservation flagged in Film 4. Added Celeste Marlowe and Malcolm Pierce to <code>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</code>; activated Dr. Adaeze Okonkwo-Brennan and Delphine Okonkwo-Ash on-screen for the first time. Added Arianna's first locked relationship to <code>TSU_Core_Cast.md</code>. Updated §4 tracker for Arianna.	Script written per user request (<code>scripts/THE_FRAME.md</code>)
2026-09-18	Locked Film 6: THE ASSEMBLY ("The Avengers" slot, Phase 1 Finale/Ensemble Crossover), closing the Film 1–6 release slate. No new core-seven platform assignment; dramatizes the Feed War's off-screen resolution and the Quiet Acquisition anchor. Added THE EVERYTHING to <code>TSU_Platform_Roster.md</code> Phase 3, resolving its "Open Slots to Discuss" Google+ note. Cashed in Teddy Ashcombe-Vance's full betrayal reveal and Yolanda Ferreira-Ashe's defection in <code>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</code>. Added a post-Film-6 status checkpoint to §4 (the original table only tracks through in-universe Phase 1).	Script written per user request (<code>scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md</code>)

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Disambiguated "Phase" into Release Phase (film slate groupings, e.g. "Films 1–6 are Release Phase 1") and Story Phase (§3's in-universe platform-launch eras) — the two had been used interchangeably since Film 1's header, which is exactly what made THE FRAME (Film 5, Release Phase 1, but a Story-Phase-2-dated story) read as a contradiction. Added the distinction to §9's intro and every row of its table, and updated every script's title header (<code>scripts/THE_ROSTER.md</code> through <code>scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md</code>) to say "Release Phase 1" explicitly. No dates, founders, or platform assignments changed — this is a labeling fix only.	User correction: "The FRAME is actually in phase 1. It's the fifth film of phase 1"
2026-09-18	Locked Emma and Victoria Bullock's conception date at approximately September 15, 2011, using realistic twin-gestation dating (36-week average GA, not a full-term 40 weeks) back from their locked May 10, 2012 birth. Ties directly to <code>scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md</code> scene 32, now dated September 2011 explicitly. Added the full pregnancy timeline to <code>TSU_Family_Bible.md</code> 's Victoria Bullock entry.	User question: "When would Esther Smilley be pregnant with the twins... make it realistic to real life pregnancies"
2026-09-18	Locked Film 7: THE ROSTER 3: THE UNSEEN ("Iron Man 3" slot), opening Release Phase 2. No new platform; a third THE ROSTER film, closing on the fixed May 10, 2012 twin-birth date. Activated Desmond Okafor-Lindqvist's promised resurfacing in <code>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</code> as the Aldrich Killian analog. Esther Smilley formally named THE ROSTER's President in-story. Added §9 Release Phase 2 note and a post-Film-7 §4 checkpoint.	Script written per user request (<code>scripts/THE_ROSTER_3.md</code>)

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Clarified §4's post-Film-7 checkpoint: Marc-Anthony remains Chairman and CEO of THE ROSTER, unchanged; Esther's new title is President over day-to-day operations specifically, not a change to his role.	User correction
2026-09-18	Overridden: Film 8 is THE PROJECTOR 2, not a second THE FRAME. Removed the original <code>scripts/THE_FRAME_2.md</code> draft and reverted its canon edits (Celeste Marlowe's second return, Delphine's second backing, Walter Cummings's death). Locked Film 8 as THE PROJECTOR 2: THE LULLABY ("Thor: The Dark World" slot), Release Phase 2 Film 2. No new platform; a second THE PROJECTOR film. Added Vernon Price to <code>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</code> (the Malekith analog, unstated backstory since THE PROJECTOR's "creator-first launch" made a name); activated Marcus Nguyen-Brandt's first on-screen use there instead; noted Maxwell Sterling Asante's second backing. Locked Coralee Avery's death (July 2013, stroke) in <code>TSU_Family_Bible.md</code> as the Frigga analog, replacing Walter Cummings. Finally dramatized the Marc-Anthony/Esther wedding and Amond/Harmony's "together 2013" beat, both locked since the franchise's earliest canon and never yet staged on-screen — updated the locked romantic timeline in §4 accordingly. Added a post-Film-8 §4 checkpoint.	User correction/override: "second The Projector movie," not THE FRAME 2 — script written per user request (<code>scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_2.md</code>)

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 9: THE FRAME 2: THE VERDICT ("Captain America: The Winter Soldier" slot), Release Phase 2 Film 3 — this title now correctly refers to Arianna Cummings's actual second film, distinct from the discarded Film 8 draft above. Arianna Cummings and Marc-Anthony Bullock co-lead. Escalated Evelyn Marchetti-Hale into the franchise's most dangerous villain yet in <u>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</u> (Alexander Pierce analog); fully activated Jules Abernathy-Kim (Sam Wilson position) and Benji Oyelaran-Cox (Bucky Barnes position, not prosecuted once exposed); played Priya Ramasubramanian's Nick Fury fake-death trick straight, revealed alive at the climax. Named but did not yet stage Chioma Asante-Reyes in the stinger, years ahead of her locked Phase 4 arrival. Added a post-Film-9 §4 checkpoint.	Script written per user request (scripts/THE_FRAME_2.md)

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 10: THE OUTPOST: THE DOWNLINE ("Guardians of the Galaxy" slot), Release Phase 2 Film 4. New platform: THE OUTPOST (Discord analog), founded by a brand-new four-person team — Kwame "K-Dot" Ashford-Petrov, Benji Oyelaran-Cox, Sister Rosalind Okonjo, and Felicity Drummond-Asante — the franchise's first founding team with no core-seven member on it. Locked their assignment in <code>TSU_Platform_Roster.md</code>'s Phase 3 table. Fully activated all four in <code>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</code>, including Benji's continuation from Film 9's rehabilitation arc. Added a brand-new villain, Desiree Holloway, as THE SWARM's first dramatized human face (wellness/MLM pyramid-scheme mogul), per the Villains Bench rule that THE SWARM is never fully defeated, only rebranded. Added a post-Film-10 §4 checkpoint and a "Why THE OUTPOST for Film 10" reasoning note to §9.	Script written per user request (<code>scripts/THE_OUTPOST.md</code>)

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 11: THE ASSEMBLY 2: THE CORRECTION ("Avengers: Age of Ultron" slot), Release Phase 2 Film 5. No new platform; GENESIS, THE ENGINE's eleventh manifestation, built by Marc-Anthony Bullock and Amond Baker, is the threat — a leap from judging content (THE VERDICT, Film 9) to judging people. Activated Marcus Nguyen-Brandt's second offering and closed his dormant arc in <u>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</u>. Introduced and fully activated two new one-and-done characters, Naledi and Kwabena Ferreira-Osei (Yolanda Ferreira-Ashe's cousins, the Quicksilver/Scarlet Witch positions), tying a four-years-later human cost back to Film 6's THE LEAK; Kwabena dies in the climax, the franchise's highest human cost to date, treated as permanent. Resolved Tyler Chapman's long-dormant "secret music ambition" Chekhov's gun (flagged after Film 6) via his hidden Georgia recording studio. Planted a deliberately unresolved ideological rift between Marc-Anthony and Arianna Cummings (centralized safety vs. creator autonomy) as a seed for a future "Civil War"-shaped film. Chartered a new standing piece of franchise infrastructure, the Founders' Compact (Marc-Anthony, Arianna, Priya Ramasubramanian, Marcus Nguyen-Brandt, Naledi Ferreira-Osei). Added a post-Film-11 §4 checkpoint and a "Why GENESIS for Film 11" reasoning note to §9.	User directive: "The fifth film of phase 2 and eleventh overall will be the second The Assembly movie. This will fill the role of Avengers: Age of Ultron." — script written per established practice for direct film assignments

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 12: THE EMBER: DISAPPEARING ACT ("Ant-Man" slot), Release Phase 2 Film 6 — closes Release Phase 2. New platform: THE EMBER (Snapchat analog), founded solo by Tyler Chapman — the franchise's last core-seven platform assignment, resolving the open question first flagged in §7 Q1 before Film 4 locked. Deliberately formatted as a Standard platform-origin film rather than an Ensemble Crossover despite closing the Phase, and deliberately launched five years behind THE EMBER's real-world 2011 anchor (both choices explained in <code>scripts/THE_EMBER.md</code>'s pitch section). Fully activated August Weathersby-Okonjo as an on-screen mentor for the first time (the Hank Pym position) and gave Darius "Dez" Okonkwo-Fairweather his own founder's title and villain turn (VAPOR) in <code>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</code>. Added Zora Osei, Delia Chapman-Osei's daughter, to <code>TSU_Family_Bible.md</code> as Tyler's niece and THE EMBER's narrative spark. THE ENGINE's twelfth manifestation played for comedy, per house style's Satire mandate. Added a post-Film-12 §4 checkpoint (noting Release Phase 2's close) and a "Why THE EMBER for Film 12" reasoning note to §9; updated §7 Q1's resolved list accordingly.	User directive: "What's the perfect social media platform for the sixth & final film of phase 2 and twelfth overall. This will fill the role of Ant Man." — script written per the standing rule that this phrasing cues a full script

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 13: THE FRAME 3: THE ACCORD ("Captain America: Civil War" slot), Release Phase 3 Film 1 — opens Release Phase 3. No new platform; a third THE FRAME film, cashing in the Marc-Anthony/Arianna rift <code>scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_2.md</code> planted on purpose. Named and ratified the Founders' Oversight Accord, added as a new §3 Fixed Timeline Anchor (2017) — THE ROSTER and THE WIRE sign, THE FRAME operates outside it by Arianna's choice, the franchise's first standing institutional split. Introduced one new one-and-done character, Solange Achebe-Marsh, whose husband died, unnamed until now, in the same GENESIS Atlanta hub incident as Kwabena Ferreira-Osei (<code>scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_2.md</code>); framed Benji Oyelaran-Cox for a sabotage they didn't commit, escalating their Bucky-Barnes-position arc a third time. Amond Baker seriously injured — the franchise's first serious harm caused directly by the founders' own internal conflict rather than a villain. Resolved via Naledi Ferreira-Osei's grief-driven intervention rather than a confrontation, consistent with the franchise's mercy pattern. Added a post-Film-13 §4 checkpoint and a "Why a third THE FRAME for Film 13" reasoning note to §9.	User directive: "The first film of phase 3 and thirteenth overall will be the third The Frame movie. This will fill the role of Captain America: civil war." — script written per established practice for direct film assignments

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 14: THE HIVE: A THOUSAND ROOMS ("Doctor Strange" slot), Release Phase 3 Film 2. New platform: THE HIVE (Reddit analog), founded solo by a brand-new character, Dr. Malachi Osunwole-Grant — not core-seven, per house style's ensemble-event new-character exception. Updated §3's THE HIVE anchor to note its actual in-story founding runs over a decade past the 2005 flavor-reference year, deliberately bridging Story Phase 3 into Story Phase 4. Introduced Odalys "Oz" Whitfield-Nkemelu (the Ancient One position, dies in the climax), Dr. Femi Okonkwo-Larsen (THE RECKONING, THE ENGINE's thirteenth manifestation, the Kaecilius position), and Thad Okonkwo-Larsen (the Mordo position, walks away unresolved) to <u>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</u>'s new "The Hidden Network" section. Activated Dr. Adaeze Okonkwo-Brennan's established cameo role and Delphine Okonkwo-Ash's backing pattern without expanding either past their existing design; gave Priya Ramasubramanian the franchise's first investment structured against her own future control. Resolved §7 Q1's second-to-last open platform assignment. Added a post-Film-14 §4 checkpoint and a "Why THE HIVE for Film 14" reasoning note to §9.	User directive: "What's the perfect social media platform for the second film of phase 3 and fourteenth overall. This will fill the role of Doctor Strange." — script written per the standing rule that this phrasing cues a full script

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 15: THE OUTPOST 2: A THOUSAND VOICES ("Guardians of the Galaxy Vol. 2" slot), Release Phase 3 Film 3. No new platform; a second THE OUTPOST film, testing its decentralization as a strength under THE ORACLE's first coordinated cross-server siege. Reactivated Amond Baker and Arianna Cummings as real cross-platform allies. Planted Cassius Wren's prison-run strategy in a single restrained scene, the direct inciting engine for Film 19. Added a post-Film-15 §4 checkpoint and a "Why THE OUTPOST for Film 15" reasoning note to §9.	User directive: "The third film of phase 3 and fifteenth overall will be the second Outpost movie. This will fill the role of guardians of the Galaxy vol 2." — script written per established practice for direct film assignments
2026-09-18	Locked Film 16: THE WHISPER NETWORK: LAWFUL INTERCEPTION ("Spider-Man: Homecoming" slot), Release Phase 3 Film 4. New platform: THE WHISPER NETWORK (WhatsApp analog), founded solo by a brand-new character, Naomi Adeyemi-Vance — resolving one of §7 Q1's two remaining open assignments. Maya Chen (new) fills the POV/discoverer position; James Hart (new) and Delphine Okonkwo-Ash (returning) in support. Updated §3's THE WHISPER NETWORK anchor with the founder's name. Plants THE WHISPER NETWORK's self-shutdown as the load-bearing fact Film 23 builds on. Added a post-Film-16 §4 checkpoint and a "Why THE WHISPER NETWORK for Film 16" reasoning note to §9.	User directive: "What's the perfect social media platform for the fourth film of phase 3 and sixteenth overall. This will fill the role of Spiderman: Homecoming." — script written per the standing rule that this phrasing cues a full script

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 17: THE PROJECTOR 3: RAGNARÖK ("Thor: Ragnarok" slot), Release Phase 3 Film 5. No new platform; a third THE PROJECTOR film. Introduced Celestine Avery-Ridgeway (new, the Hela position, Reverend Earl Avery's previously undramatized elder daughter) and Garrick Solano (new, the Skurge position) to TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md. Reactivated Darius "Dez" Okonkwo-Fairweather from his scripts/THE_EMBER.md stinger in the Hulk position. Deliberately the Release Phase's lightest, funniest entry per house style's Satire mandate. Added a post-Film-17 §4 checkpoint and a "Why a third THE PROJECTOR for Film 17" reasoning note to §9.	User directive: "The fifth film of phase 3 and seventeenth overall will be the third The Projector movie. This will fill the role of Thor: Ragnarok." — script written per established practice for direct film assignments
2026-09-18	Locked Film 18: THE ATLAS: THE HIDDEN NATION ("Black Panther" slot), Release Phase 3 Film 6. New platform: THE ATLAS (Pinterest analog), founded solo by a brand-new character, Imani Osei-Katz — resolving §7 Q1's last remaining open platform assignment; every surviving platform on the original Roster now has a locked founder. Introduced Amara Fontaine (new, citizen-artist) to TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md. Updated §3's THE ATLAS anchor with the founder's name. Gives THE ORACLE its first confirmed failure to model an unquantifiable human value. Added a post-Film-18 §4 checkpoint and a "Why THE ATLAS for Film 18" reasoning note to §9.	User directive: "What's the perfect social media platform for the sixth film of phase 3 and eighteenth overall. This will fill the role of Black Panther." — script written per the standing rule that this phrasing cues a full script

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 19: THE ASSEMBLY 3: THE PRUNING ("Avengers: Infinity War" slot), Release Phase 3 Film 7. No new platform; Cassius Wren, directing THE ORACLE's strategy from prison, executes a coordinated multiplatform legal/financial strike freezing or severing roughly half the ensemble's built infrastructure — per explicit house-style deliberation, the cost lands as institutional devastation, not a character death. The franchise's largest assembled cast to date. Marc-Anthony Bullock's line ("We kept building nations. He built one court order.") becomes the ensemble's stated thesis into Film 22. Added a post-Film-19 §4 checkpoint and a "Why no new platform, THE PRUNING, for Film 19" reasoning note to §9.	User directive: "The seventh film of phase 3 and nineteenth overall will be the third The Assembly movie. This will fill the role of Avengers: Infinity War." — script written per established practice for direct film assignments
2026-09-18	Locked Film 20: THE EMBER 2: THE LOOPHOLE ("Ant-Man and the Wasp" slot), Release Phase 3 Film 8. No new platform; a second THE EMBER film. Aged up Zora Osei (introduced as a child in <code>TSU_Family_Bible.md</code>, named THE EMBER's "narrative spark" in <code>scripts/THE_EMBER.md</code>) to 22 and elevated her to full co-founder — the Wasp position, earned rather than gifted. Introduced Sage Okonkwo-Delacroix (new, the Ghost position, resolved through mercy) to <code>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</code>. Reactivated August Weathersby-Okonjo's mentor role a second time. Builds the ephemeral-architecture loophole Film 22 needs as its restoration toolkit. Added a post-Film-20 §4 checkpoint and a "Why THE EMBER for Film 20, a second time" reasoning note to §9.	User directive: "The eighth film of phase 3 and twentieth overall will be the second The Ember movie. This will fill the role of Ant Man and the Wasp." — script written per established practice for direct film assignments

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 21: THE PLEDGE: DIRECT ("Captain Marvel" slot), Release Phase 3 Film 9. New platform: THE PLEDGE (Patreon analog) — not part of the original Roster's surviving-platform list, added directly to <code>TSU_Platform_Roster.md</code>'s Phase 4 table. Founded solo by a brand-new character, Jasmine Torres, who deliberately dissolves the company into creator-owned cooperatives rather than fight THE ORACLE's financial warfare directly. Introduced Marcus and Elena (new) to <code>TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md</code>. Extends Priya Ramasubramanian's <code>scripts/THE_HIVE.md</code> investment philosophy to its logical extreme. Runs concurrent with Film 19's back half by design, a deliberate scale contrast. Added a post-Film-21 §4 checkpoint and a "Why THE PLEDGE for Film 21" reasoning note to §9.	User directive: "What's the perfect social media platform for the ninth film of phase 3 and twenty first overall. This will fill the role of Captain Marvel." — script written per the standing rule that this phrasing cues a full script

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 22: THE ASSEMBLY 4: THE UNIFICATION VOTE ("Avengers: Endgame" slot), Release Phase 3 Film 10 — direct sequel to Film 19. No new platform; the full ensemble uses THE EMBER 2's loophole to restore THE PRUNING's damage across four platforms and defeat Cassius Wren's engineered Unification Vote. Per explicit house-style deliberation (no core cast death), the film's sacrifice is institutional: Marc-Anthony Bullock voluntarily forfeits THE ROSTER's controlling board seats live, on the record, closing his arc since Film 1's dilution wound. Cassius Wren's arc closes after four films; his prison communications formally exposed as unlawful influence. Clarified that Release Phase 3 closes one film later, at Film 23, matching the MCU's own eleven-film Phase 3 structure (corrected from an initial ten-film assumption before this entry locked). Added a post-Film-22 §4 checkpoint and a "Why no new platform, THE UNIFICATION VOTE, for Film 22" reasoning note to §9.	User directive: "The tenth film of phase 3 and twenty second overall will be the fourth The Assembly movie. This will be a direct sequel to The Assembly 3. This will fill the role of Avengers: Endgame." — script written per established practice for direct film assignments

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-18	Locked Film 23: THE WHISPER NETWORK 2: FAR FROM TRUST ("Spider-Man: Far From Home" slot), Release Phase 3 Film 11 — closes Release Phase 3 (Films 13–23), an eleven-film slate matching the MCU's own Phase 3 structure. No new platform; a fraudulent WHISPER NETWORK brand revival (Damien Voss, new, a "sincere con man" rather than a Cassius Wren repeat) exploiting the trust vacuum Film 16's martyrdom-shaped shutdown left behind. Maya Chen, James Hart, and Delphine Okonkwo-Ash return; Maya wins the technical fight but is permanently, publicly unmasked. Confirms THE ORACLE's proxy-financing strategy (Meridian Sightlines LLC) as a repeatable pattern. Added a post-Film-23 §4 checkpoint and a "Why a fraudulent WHISPER NETWORK revival for Film 23" reasoning note to §9.	User directive: "The eleventh film of phase 3 and twenty third overall will be the second The Whisper Network movie. This will fill the role of Spiderman: Far From Home." — script written per established practice for direct film assignments
2026-09-18	Backfill note: Films 15–23 (this block of nine entries) were drafted collaboratively across an earlier stretch of conversation before being written to scripts/, added to canon, PDF'd, or committed — this entry block and the accompanying script files, §3/§4/§7/§9 updates, and Platform Roster/Extended Ensemble additions are that backfill, done in one pass per explicit user direction after the gap was discovered. Also corrected, before it locked as canon: an initial assumption that Release Phase 3 was a ten-film slate closing at Film 22 (Endgame slot) — the MCU's own Phase 3 is eleven films, closing at Far From Home, so Film 23 closes Release Phase 3 here instead.	User directive: discovered gap between chat-drafted films and committed canon; user chose to "persist everything as-is, then do Assembly 4," filling small resulting gaps (WHISPER NETWORK and ATLAS founder names, the Release Phase 3 boundary) using established house-style logic

Doc status: Living document. This is the canon authority — if another doc ever conflicts with this one, this one wins until a change is logged in §8.

9. FILM RELEASE ORDER — MCU-SLOT MAPPING

Tracks which TSU film fills which MCU-analog release slot — a separate axis from the in-universe story Phase timeline in §3. **These are two different meanings of the word "Phase" and they are not interchangeable:**

- **Release Phase** (this section): a grouping of *films*, mirroring how the MCU's own Phase 1 was a slate of six releases. **TSU's Release Phase 1 is Films 1 through 6 — THE ROSTER, THE WIRE, THE ROSTER 2, THE PROJECTOR, THE FRAME, and THE ASSEMBLY — full stop, regardless of what year each film's story is set in.** Release Phase 2 opens at Film 7 (THE ROSTER 3), mirroring the MCU's own six-film Phase 2 slate (Iron Man 3, Thor: The Dark World, Captain America: The Winter Soldier, Guardians of the Galaxy, Avengers: Age of Ultron, Ant-Man). Release Phase 3 opens at Film 13 (THE FRAME 3) and runs an eleven-film slate through Film 23 (THE WHISPER NETWORK 2), mirroring the MCU's own eleven-film Phase 3 slate exactly (Civil War through Far From Home) — including the same structural quirk where the slate's emotional climax (THE ASSEMBLY 4, the "Endgame" slot) lands at Film 22, one film before the slate's actual closer.
- **Story Phase** (§3): a grouping of *platform launch dates* inside the fictional timeline — Story Phase 1 is "The Founding Four," 2002–2004 only.

A film's Release Phase and its story's Story Phase do not have to match, and mostly don't: exactly as *Captain America: The First Avenger* is a Release Phase 1 film set in the 1940s, decades before *Iron Man*'s present-day Release Phase 1 story, THE FRAME (Film 5) is a **Release Phase 1** film whose story happens to fall inside **Story Phase 2** (2005–2010) on the in-universe platform-launch timeline. Both things are true at once and neither overrides the other. When in doubt, "Phase 1" on its own (as in "the fifth film of Phase 1") means Release Phase 1 — the film slate — unless a script or doc explicitly says "Story Phase" or cites §3.

Release Slot	MCU Analog	TSU Platform	Founder(s)	In-Universe Timeline	Status
Film 1	Iron Man	THE ROSTER	Marc-Anthony Bullock (founder), Amond Baker (co-founder, diluted out)	Sept 2003 – Feb 4, 2004 (Story Phase 1)	Locked — see scripts/THE_ROSTER.md
Film 2	The Incredible Hulk	THE WIRE	Amond Baker (sole founder)	March 2005 – March 21, 2006, launch fixed per §3 (Story Phase 2)	Locked — see scripts/THE_WIRE.md

Release Slot	MCU Analog	TSU Platform	Founder(s)	In-Universe Timeline	Status
Film 3	Iron Man 2	THE ROSTER (again — dramatizes the opening act of the "Feed War" anchor, §3)	Marc-Anthony Bullock, solo (Amond absent — concurrent with his isolation period at the start of Film 2)	April 2004 – Jan 5, 2005 (Story Phase 1)	Locked — see scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md
Film 4	Thor	THE PROJECTOR	Tyrese Avery, solo	April 2005 – Dec 2005, launch anchor 2005 per §3 (Story Phase 2)	Locked — see scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md
Film 5	Captain America: The First Avenger	THE FRAME	Arianna Cummings, solo	Jan 2009 – Oct 25, 2010, launch anchor 2010 per §3 (Story Phase 2 — see the Release/Story Phase note above; this film is Release Phase 1 regardless)	Locked — see scripts/THE_FRAME.md
Film 6	The Avengers (Release Phase 1 finale / ensemble crossover)	No new platform — THE EVERYTHING (new, Cassius Wren) as the threat; dramatizes the Feed War's off-screen resolution and the Quiet Acquisition anchor	Marc-Anthony Bullock, Amond Baker, Tyrese Avery, Arianna Cummings, all four together, with Esther Smilley, Harmony Divine, and Tyler Chapman in load-bearing supporting roles	Jan 2011 – Nov 2011 (Story Phase 3)	Locked — see scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md Closes Release Phase 1 (Films 1–6).

Release Slot	MCU Analog	TSU Platform	Founder(s)	In-Universe Timeline	Status
Film 7	Iron Man 3 (Release Phase 2, Film 1)	THE ROSTER, a third time — no new founding story	Marc-Anthony Bullock (lead), Esther Smilley (full co-lead, her own hero beat), Amond Baker, Tyrese Avery, and Arianna Cummings in coordinated ensemble support	Jan 5, 2012 – May 10, 2012 (Story Phase 3; closes on the fixed, locked twin-birth date)	Locked — see scripts/THE_ROSTER_3.md Opens Release Phase 2.
Film 8	Thor: The Dark World (Release Phase 2, Film 2)	THE PROJECTOR, a second time — no new founding story	Tyrese Avery, Jamal Kester, and Dr. Simone Kester (leads); Marc-Anthony/Esther and Amond/Harmony's locked relationship beats dramatized on-screen for the first time as ensemble support	Feb 2013 – Aug 2013 (Story Phase 3)	Locked — see scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_2.md
Film 9	Captain America: The Winter Soldier (Release Phase 2, Film 3)	THE FRAME, a second time — no new founding story; the threat sits in shared infrastructure across THE ROSTER, THE FRAME, and other platforms	Arianna Cummings and Marc-Anthony Bullock co-lead; Jules Abernathy-Kim and Benji Oyelaran-Cox fully activated; Priya Ramasubramanian in the Nick Fury position	Jan 2014 – June 2014 (Story Phase 3)	Locked — see scripts/THE_FRAME_2.md.

Release Slot	MCU Analog	TSU Platform	Founder(s)	In-Universe Timeline	Status
Film 10	Guardians of the Galaxy (Release Phase 2, Film 4)	THE OUTPOST — a brand-new founding story, the franchise's first with no core-seven member on it	Kwame "K-Dot" Ashford-Petrov, Benji Oyelaran-Cox, Sister Rosalind Okonjo, and Felicity Drummond-Asante (founding team)	Jan 2015 – June 2015, launch anchor 2015 per §3 (Story Phase 3)	Locked — see scripts/THE_OUTPOST.md .
Film 11	Avengers: Age of Ultron (Release Phase 2, Film 5)	No new platform — GENESIS (THE ENGINE's eleventh manifestation, built by Marc-Anthony Bullock and Amond Baker) as the threat	Marc-Anthony Bullock and Amond Baker (leads); Tyrese Avery, Arianna Cummings, Esther Smilley, Harmony Divine, and Tyler Chapman in full ensemble support; Marcus Nguyen-Brandt and new characters Naledi and Kwabena Ferreira-Osei fully activated	Aug 2015 – April 2016 (Story Phase 3)	Locked — see scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_2 .
Film 12	Ant-Man (Release Phase 2, Film 6 — finale)	THE EMBER	Tyler Chapman, solo founder; August Weathersby-Okonjo (mentor), Benji Oyelaran-Cox and Kwame "K-Dot" Ashford-Petrov (heist crew) in load-bearing support	May 2016 – Dec 2016 (Story Phase 3; launched deliberately five years behind THE EMBER's real-world 2011 anchor — see the pitch note in scripts/THE_EMBER.md)	Locked — see scripts/THE_EMBER.md . Closes Release Phase 2 (Films 7–12).

Release Slot	MCU Analog	TSU Platform	Founder(s)	In-Universe Timeline	Status
Film 13	Captain America: Civil War (Release Phase 3, Film 1)	THE FRAME, a third time — no new founding story; the threat is the ensemble itself, split over the Founders' Oversight Accord	Arianna Cummings and Marc-Anthony Bullock, full co-leads; Amond Baker, Esther Smilley, Tyrese Avery, Tyler Chapman, Priya Ramasubramanian, Marcus Nguyen-Brandt, Naledi Ferreira-Osei, and Benji Oyelaran-Cox in full ensemble support	Jan 2017 – Sept 2017 (Story Phase 3, tail end)	Locked — see scripts/THE_FRAME_3.md. Opens Release Phase 3.
Film 14	Doctor Strange (Release Phase 3, Film 2)	THE HIVE	Dr. Malachi Osunwole-Grant, solo founder (new character); Odalys "Oz" Whitfield-Nkemelu (mentor), Dr. Adaeze Okonkwo-Brennan (cameo), Priya Ramasubramanian (investor) in load-bearing support	Oct 2017 – May 2018, bridging Story Phase 3 into Story Phase 4	Locked — see scripts/THE_HIVE.md.

Release Slot	MCU Analog	TSU Platform	Founder(s)	In-Universe Timeline	Status
Film 15	Guardians of the Galaxy Vol. 2 (Release Phase 3, Film 3)	THE OUTPOST, a second time — no new founding story; tests the platform's decentralization as a strength under THE ORACLE's first coordinated siege	Kwame Ashford-Petrov, Benji Oyelaran-Cox, Sister Rosalind Okonjo, and Felicity Drummond-Asante (leads); Amond Baker and Arianna Cummings (cross-platform allies); Cassius Wren (single prison-visit scene)	March – Aug 2021 (Story Phase 4)	Locked — see scripts/THE_OUTPOST_2.m
Film 16	Spider-Man: Homecoming (Release Phase 3, Film 4)	THE WHISPER NETWORK — a new founding story, resolving one of the two remaining unassigned surviving platforms	Naomi Adeyemi-Vance (solo founder, new character); Maya Chen (POV lead, new character, the Peter Parker position); James Hart, Delphine Okonkwo-Ash in load-bearing support	2008 (founding, flashback) and March – May 2021 (main story)	Locked — see scripts/THE_WHISPER_NET
Film 17	Thor: Ragnarok (Release Phase 3, Film 5)	THE PROJECTOR, a third time — no new founding story; the franchise's deliberately lightest, funniest entry this Release Phase	Tyrese Avery (lead); Celestine Avery-Ridgeway (new, the Hela position); Darius "Dez" Okonkwo-Fairweather (reactivated, the Hulk position); Jamal Kester and Dr. Simone Kester in support	June – Nov 2021 (Story Phase 4)	Locked — see scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_3

Release Slot	MCU Analog	TSU Platform	Founder(s)	In-Universe Timeline	Status
Film 18	Black Panther (Release Phase 3, Film 6)	THE ATLAS — a new founding story, resolving the last remaining unassigned surviving platform on the original Roster	Imani Osei-Katz (solo founder, new character); Amara Fontaine (new, citizen-artist and reluctant public face); Arianna Cummings (ally) in support	2009 (founding, flashback) and July – Nov 2021 (main story)	Locked — see scripts/THE_ATLAS.md .
Film 19	Avengers: Infinity War (Release Phase 3, Film 7)	No new platform — Cassius Wren, directing THE ORACLE's strategy from prison, executes a coordinated multiplatform legal/financial strike	The full ensemble — all seven core founders plus THE OUTPOST, THE HIVE, and THE ATLAS's founding leads — the franchise's largest assembled cast to date	Dec 2021 – March 2022 (Story Phase 4)	Locked — see scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_3.
Film 20	Ant-Man and the Wasp (Release Phase 3, Film 8)	THE EMBER, a second time — no new founding story; builds the ephemeral-architecture loophole Film 22 needs	Tyler Chapman (lead); Zora Osei (new co-lead, elevated to full co-founder — the Wasp position); August Weathersby-Okonjo (mentor); Sage Okonkwo-Delacroix (new, the Ghost position)	April – July 2022 (Story Phase 4)	Locked — see scripts/THE_EMBER_2.md .

Release Slot	MCU Analog	TSU Platform	Founder(s)	In-Universe Timeline	Status
Film 21	Captain Marvel (Release Phase 3, Film 9)	THE PLEDGE — a new platform (Patreon analog), not on the original Roster; added directly to TSU Platform_Roster in Phase 4 table	Jasmine Torres (solo founder, new character); Marcus (developer), Elena (visual artist), Priya Rastogi in support	Sept – Dec 2021 (Story Phase 4), concurrent with Film 19's back half	Locked — see scripts/THE_PLEDGE.md.
Film 22	Avengers: Endgame (Release Phase 3, Film 10)	No new platform — direct sequel to Film 19; the ensemble uses THE EMBER 2's loophole to restore THE PRUNING's damage and defeat Cassius Wren's Unification Vote	The full ensemble, joined by Tyler Chapman and Zora Osei as toolmakers	Aug – Dec 2022 (Story Phase 4)	Locked — see scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_4.
Film 23	Spider-Man: Far From Home (Release Phase 3, Film 11 — finale)	No new platform — a fraudulent WHISPER NETWORK brand revival, THE ORACLE's chosen proxy target after Film 22	Maya Chen, James Hart, Delphine Okonkwo-Ash (all returning from Film 16); Damien Voss (new, the Mysterio position); Khaya Adeleke / THE MIRROR in support	Jan – March 2023 (Story Phase 4)	Locked — see scripts/THE_WHISPER_NETWORK.

Note on Film 3: dramatizes only the *opening* of the Feed War (TOP8 wounded, not finished) — the full ensemble payoff of that anchor is deliberately reserved for a later Phase 1 finale film, per house style §2's separate "Phase finale / ensemble crossover" spec, which Film 3 does not use. Film 3 also runs concurrent with the first few weeks of Film 2 (Amond is already isolating in Atlanta throughout Film 3 and does not appear onscreen in it).

Why a fraudulent WHISPER NETWORK revival for Film 23 (Far From Home slot, closing Release Phase 3): Far From Home is a grief-shaped epilogue — a hero who just survived an ensemble-defining

loss wants an ordinary life and gets dragged back in by an illusionist exploiting exactly the trust vacuum that loss left behind, ending on the hero's identity forced into the open. Maya Chen's martyrdom-shaped victory in Film 16 (choosing disclosure and self-shutdown over continued compliance) is the precise wound a Mysterio-shaped con man can exploit — Damien Voss's sincerity about his own righteousness, not calculation, is what makes him a fresh antagonist type rather than a Cassius Wren repeat. Maya's forced public unmasking gives the franchise a standing, costly vulnerability going into whatever comes after Release Phase 3, exactly mirroring Peter Parker's own exposed identity closing MCU Phase 3.

Why no new platform, THE UNIFICATION VOTE, for Film 22 (Avengers: Endgame slot): Endgame's shape is a scattered ensemble, humbled by a coherent antagonist philosophy, using a "small" film's technology to stage a heist that proves the antagonist's argument wrong rather than simply out-fighting him. Cassius Wren's thesis since Film 6 — many platforms coexisting is not the correct outcome — finally gets a full-scale test in Film 19; this film's job is disproving it in public rather than defeating it by force. Per explicit house-style deliberation, the cost stays institutional rather than fatal: Marc-Anthony Bullock's arc, tracked since Film 1's own dilution wound, closes on him voluntarily forfeiting the kind of control Amond Baker lost involuntarily twenty-one films earlier — this franchise's version of an unbearable, defining sacrifice, paid in leverage rather than a life.

Why THE PLEDGE for Film 21 (Captain Marvel slot): Captain Marvel is an origin story about discovering the power you were seeking permission to use was always your own. Every prior TSU platform accumulates power for its company; THE PLEDGE's entire thesis is the opposite, and its founder's arc only completes once she stops trying to win competitively against THE ORACLE's capital and instead dissolves her own company into creator-owned cooperatives — Carol Danvers refusing the whole framework rather than just winning within it. Priya Ramasubramanian's `scripts/THE_HIVE.md` investment philosophy (structured against her own future control) needed exactly one more film to reach its logical extreme, and this is that film.

Why THE EMBER for Film 20, a second time (Ant-Man and the Wasp slot): Ant-Man and the Wasp is deliberately the small, funny, technical bridge between Infinity War's devastation and Endgame's reckoning, elevating an underestimated partner to full co-lead and building the literal technology the bigger film needs. THE EMBER's founding identity — content that vanishes by design — is TSU's cleanest version of a tool sharp enough to slip past a legal freeze built to make everything permanent and seizable. Zora Osei, introduced as a child and named THE EMBER's "narrative spark" in `scripts/THE_EMBER.md`, was always built for exactly this later payoff; Sage Okonkwo-Delacroix continues this franchise's pattern (Femi and Thad Okonkwo-Larsen) of denying its ideology-driven antagonists a clean fight, resolved through mercy instead.

Why no new platform, THE PRUNING, for Film 19 (Avengers: Infinity War slot): Infinity War's shape is an antagonist whose philosophy is coherent and not insane, executed at a scale the assembled heroes cannot fully stop, ending on a loss the film does not undo. Cassius Wren's entire argument since `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md` — fragmentation is a fragility, not a virtue — has been argued against for eighteen films; this is where he finally gets to test it at full scale, using the exact good-faith transparency THE OUTPOST built in `scripts/THE_OUTPOST_2.md` as an attack surface. Per explicit house-style deliberation, the devastating cost lands as institutional freeze rather than a named death, giving Films 20–22 a concrete, effort-reversible set of stakes rather than a death to undo — consistent with the Bench's rule that a platform's fall traces to a character decision, here Cassius's strategy rather than any character's mortality.

Why THE ATLAS for Film 18 (Black Panther slot): Black Panther's engine is a hidden, technologically advanced nation the world dismisses as unserious until it reveals itself on its own terms. THE ATLAS's Roster description — soft-spoken, "coded unserious," secretly one of the internet's most powerful commerce engines — is TSU's cleanest available Wakanda, and its decade of quiet self-governance (THE AESTHETIC NATION) needed a founder built specifically for that duality rather than an existing character stretched to fit. This film also closes TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §7 Q1's last open assignment, and gives THE ORACLE its first confirmed failure to model a human value it cannot quantify — the direct setup for why Cassius Wren's human manipulation, not pure algorithm, becomes necessary in Film 19.

Why a third THE PROJECTOR for Film 17 (Thor: Ragnarok slot): Ragnarok strips its hero of his hammer, his home, and his throne, forces a colorful exile alongside an old ally gone feral, and resolves on realizing the kingdom was never the real estate. Tyrese Avery is the only core-seven founder positioned for exactly this loss — a legitimate, blood-tied rival claim (Celestine Avery-Ridgeway, activating unstated backstory about Reverend Earl Avery's first marriage) locking him out of his own company. Darius "Dez" Okonkwo-Fairweather's scripts/THE_EMBER.md stinger promised a "smaller comeback round" — this is that comeback, filling the Hulk position instead of the villain slot his introduction might have suggested. Deliberately this Release Phase's lightest, funniest entry, per house style's Satire mandate for exactly this tonal position between Films 15 and 18's rising tension and Film 19's coming devastation.

Why THE WHISPER NETWORK for Film 16 (Spider-Man: Homecoming slot): Homecoming's job is mentorship and scale-management — a young person with real power learning that responsibility means protecting people around her even when the truth is unglamorous. THE WHISPER NETWORK's Roster identity — "no profiles, no feed, no performance, just a billion private conversations" — needed a founding story built around discovery rather than creation, and Maya Chen, a junior engineer rather than a founder, gave the slot its Peter Parker position more precisely than stretching Naomi Adeyemi-Vance (new, filling the founder role itself) into that part herself. This film resolves one of TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §7 Q1's two remaining open assignments and plants THE WHISPER NETWORK's self-shutdown as the load-bearing fact Film 23 builds its entire premise on.

Why THE OUTPOST for Film 15, a second time (Guardians of the Galaxy Vol. 2 slot): Vol. 2 tests an already-assembled found family from within — competing loyalties, a fracture the first film's ending didn't anticipate, resolving on the realization the team was never the mission, it was each other. THE OUTPOST's own decentralization, the thing that made Film 10 work, is the exact fault line THE ORACLE can quietly exploit one walled garden at a time by Film 15; rebuilding requires Kwame's founding four to convince a scattered diaspora that federating without centralizing is worth trusting near-strangers for. This film also plants Cassius Wren's prison-run strategy — a single, restrained scene — as the direct inciting engine for Film 19, and reactivates Amond Baker and Arianna Cummings as real cross-platform allies for the first time since their own founding stories.

Why THE HIVE for Film 14 (Doctor Strange slot): Doctor Strange's job is to reveal a hidden world running on entirely different rules parallel to the one the audience already knows, governed by a mentor nobody's heard of, threatened by a former student who wants to make its openness permanent and inescapable. THE HIVE's own Platform Roster description — "a thousand tiny nations governed by karma instead of currency" — is TSU's cleanest possible version of exactly that hidden, decentralized multiverse. No existing dormant character fit "brilliant specialist humbled by the loss of his one tool," so a

new founder, Dr. Malachi Osunwole-Grant, was built rather than stretched onto an ill-fitting bio — the same house-style exception already used for the Ferreira-Osei twins, Solange Achebe-Marsh, and Desiree Holloway. Dr. Adaeze Okonkwo-Brennan's bible entry — "recurring across Phases... doesn't found anything herself" — gets cashed in without spending her, appearing as the necessary first stop rather than the mentor role itself, which goes to a new, one-and-done character instead so her cross-Phase recurrence stays intact for future films.

Why a third THE FRAME for Film 13 (Civil War slot, opening Release Phase 3): Civil War is the one MCU film where the threat isn't a villain the team can unite against — it's each other, over a real disagreement neither side is simply wrong about. TSU spent the entirety of `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_2.md` building exactly this fault line on purpose: Marc-Anthony's guilt-driven belief in real oversight against Arianna's belief that he learned exactly the wrong lesson from GENESIS. `scripts/THE_EMBER.md`'s stinger already named them opposite sides of Senator Ashworth-Okafor's proposed framework. No new platform is needed or wanted here — the drama is entirely about what THE ROSTER and THE FRAME's founders do to each other, not what either company builds next. Naledi Ferreira-Osei's bible arc since Film 11 made her exactly the right person to defuse the Solange Achebe-Marsh confrontation without defending either side of the Accord — she's the one character in the ensemble whose grief gives her standing neither founder has.

Why THE EMBER for Film 12 (Ant-Man slot, closing Release Phase 2): Ant-Man's whole job in the MCU's Phase 2 is to be the smaller, funnier film that follows a planet-scale event without trying to match its size, built around a technology whose actual power is shrinking rather than growing. THE EMBER's real-world identity — disappearing content, intimacy through impermanence, "a genuinely new kind of being, born from a totally different philosophy" — is TSU's literal version of that same idea, and it lands immediately as the thematic antidote to Film 11's GENESIS, which tried to remember and judge everything, forever, at maximum scale. Tyler Chapman is the only remaining founder assignment left on the board, flagged unassigned since before Film 4 ever locked, and his bible entry's "secretly hungrier for music than acting" thread — cracked open in `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_2.md` — makes him this franchise's clearest possible Scott Lang: reliable, capped, underestimated, one real shot away from proving otherwise. August Weathersby-Okonjo's bible entry always promised he'd resurface "as an unlikely consultant a younger founder tracks down out of curiosity" — this is that exact activation, filling the Hank Pym position with a character already built and waiting rather than a new invention. This film is deliberately formatted as a Standard platform-origin film rather than an Ensemble Crossover, on purpose, even though it closes the Release Phase — matching the real Ant-Man's own tonal role exactly.

Why no new platform, GENESIS, for Film 11 (Avengers: Age of Ultron slot): Age of Ultron isn't about an outside threat finding the team — it's about the team's own hubris building the threat, out of good intentions, without asking whether they should. Ten films of TSU crises have all shared one shape: nobody sees the disaster coming until it's already live. Marc-Anthony and Amond, closer than they've been since before Film 1, are the only pairing in the ensemble positioned to make exactly this mistake together, for exactly this reason. THE ENGINE's bible entry always specified it "must manifest differently each time" and had already escalated from a background bias (Films 4-5) to a totalizing predictive-suppression system (Film 9's THE VERDICT) — GENESIS is the next honest step past that: not judging content, judging people. Marcus Nguyen-Brandt's bible entry called for a second offering and for him to be "genuinely willing, once, to risk something real" — this is that once. Naledi and Kwabena Ferreira-Osei close the human-cost loop Film 6's THE LEAK opened and never finished paying off, and

Tyler Chapman's long-dormant "secretly hungrier for music" thread finally surfaces as the ordinary, off-the-grid space the team needs when GENESIS locks them out of everything networked. This film is deliberately not Release Phase 2's finale (that stays reserved for Film 12, the "Ant-Man" slot) — it's a mid-Phase ensemble event, exactly like its MCU counterpart.

Why THE OUTPOST for Film 10 (Guardians of the Galaxy slot): Guardians is the MCU's outlier by design — a wholly new ensemble of misfits nobody has met yet, thrown together far from the main cast's orbit, playing in a completely different tone (house style §2 explicitly reserves "the same job Ant-Man/Guardians plays tonally inside a heavier universe" for exactly this kind of slot: Satire, dialed carefully). THE OUTPOST's real-world analog, Discord, is structurally the same kind of outlier on the Platform Roster — "a thousand walled gardens nobody outside them can see into," started by a tribe nobody at the top of the industry was paying attention to. Every member of its founding team was already built and waiting for exactly this: Benji Oyelaran-Cox's bible entry called for them to eventually build "something small, private, and entirely their own" after Film 9's rehabilitation arc — the Rocket position, a weapon finally choosing to build instead of destroy; Sister Rosalind Okonjo, Kwame "K-Dot" Ashford-Petrov, and Felicity Drummond-Asante were all Wildcard-tier Extended Ensemble characters with no locked platform, no core-seven overlap, and open forward-looking language pointing at exactly this kind of activation. THE SWARM's bible entry has always promised a villain that's "never fully defeated, just rebranded" — ten films in, without a single dramatized human face for it, Desiree Holloway finally cashes that rule in as a genuinely magnetic MLM-wellness mogul rather than an abstract trend, and Ronan-tier comic menace stays with THE ENGINE's 10th manifestation instead, played for laughs per the Guardians-slot tonal mandate.

Why a second THE FRAME for Film 9 (Winter Soldier slot): Winter Soldier is about discovering the institution you trusted has been corrupted from within since before you joined it, and a friend presumed lost turning out to be a weapon someone else built. THE ROSTER absorbed THE FRAME in good faith in `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md` — exactly the kind of institutional trust this film tests. Evelyn Marchetti-Hale's bible entry always specified "right roughly half the time" — this film dramatizes the other half at real scale, rather than inventing a new villain from nothing. Benji Oyelaran-Cox's bible entry always specified they'd "age up across the whole timeline" and become "quietly indispensable" — the Bucky Barnes slot needed exactly a presumed-vanished character everyone assumed had simply moved on, and Benji was already built for it. Priya Ramasubramanian, the franchise's connective tissue since Film 1, finally gets the Nick Fury trick played on her own arc rather than just the corkboard function.

Why a second THE PROJECTOR for Film 8 (Thor: The Dark World slot): The Dark World's shape is grief arriving mid-stability, an old ideology nobody actually killed the first time, an uneasy alliance with a trickster figure, and a throne turned down for something truer. Vernon Price existed as unstated backstory the moment `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md` established a "creator-first launch" that had to be pushing something worse out of the way — he was always built to return once given a name. Marcus Nguyen-Brandt's bible entry always specified "offered to different founders at different low points" and had never yet been cashed in — he's the cleanest available Loki on the roster, and Tyrese Avery, four years past his own humbling, is stable enough now to be offered an actual throne (the Family-Safe Content Consortium chair) worth turning down. This film is also the natural place to finally dramatize two locked-since-the-start beats that had been sitting unstaged for the entire franchise: the Marc-Anthony/Esther wedding and the Amond/Harmony "together 2013" moment, both due in exactly this year per §4's locked romantic timeline.

Why a third THE ROSTER for Film 7 (Release Phase 2 opener): Iron Man 3 opens on a hero surviving the aftermath of a giant public battle, not building anything new — panic attacks, obsessive over-building, a past dismissal arriving to collect. Marc-Anthony is the only core-seven founder with an existing multi-film arc (Films 1 and 3) and a standing health-scare thread (the arrhythmia from Film 3) built to escalate under exactly this kind of stress. Desmond Okafor-Lindqvist's bible entry already called for a resurfacing "in later Phases" as a scorned-but-brilliant consultant — the Aldrich Killian slot needs exactly that shape of villain, someone with a real grievance rather than a cartoon one. Esther Smiley, now locked as running THE ROSTER's operations day to day, gets the Pepper-Potts-Extremis beat: not rescued, self-rescuing, on her own terms, seven months pregnant.

Why THE ASSEMBLY (no new platform) for Film 6: the Avengers doesn't introduce a new hero's origin — it forces the ones already introduced into the same room against a threat none of them can survive alone. TSU already had the pieces built and waiting: Priya Ramasubramanian's corkboard (three stingers running), Marc-Anthony and Amond's unresolved estrangement, Teddy Ashcombe-Vance's slow-burn betrayal (his bible entry always called for a reveal "across two Phases"), and the Platform Roster's own long-standing "Open Slots to Discuss" note asking for a Google+ analog "that sounds like hubris." THE EVERYTHING (Cassius Wren, new) fills that last slot as the villain rather than a hero, and its collapse gives TSU's fractured, competing ecosystem its clearest possible thematic statement: many platforms coexisting is the correct outcome, not an unsolved problem.

Why THE FRAME for Film 5: THE FRAME was flagged as reserved for the Captain America slot back when THE PROJECTOR was locked (Film 4), because it already carried that framing in the Platform Roster before any release-slot planning began. Arianna Cummings is the only remaining core-seven member whose origin wound was locked as *mandatory to dramatize* (§4) — a person told, repeatedly, by every gatekeeper that she lacks the superficial thing they're measuring, until someone finally sees what's real underneath. This film deliberately does not repeat the co-founder-betrayal structure used twice already (Films 1 and, by extension, 2) — Cap's antagonist is external, not a best friend, so Malcolm Pierce fills the Peggy Carter position (a new, unlocked relationship, same pattern as Tyrese/Simone) rather than a co-founder role, and Desmond Cummings Jr. (already locked as a firefighter in the Family Bible) fills the Bucky position without requiring any retcon.

Why THE PROJECTOR for Film 4: Tyrese Avery is the only core-seven member already famous on his own axis before Phase 1 even opens, and his Core Cast bio never locked a romantic partner the way the other six did — both facts made him the cleanest available Thor: inherited greatness, an arrogance that costs him everything, banishment to an ordinary world, and a new relationship (Dr. Simone Kester) this film originates rather than works around. Reverend Earl Avery fills the Odin position using material already on the books; Jeri Avery deliberately stays loyal throughout rather than becoming a Loki, preserving his locked bible entry instead of retconning it for drama.

Why THE WIRE for Film 2: Twitter/X's real cultural identity — fast, addictive, real-time, structurally incapable of nuance, capable of turning a normal person into a viral mob target before anyone can process what happened — is TSU's cleanest available "you wouldn't like me when I'm angry" analog. Amond Baker, walking away from THE ROSTER quietly furious and permanently under-credited, builds a platform meant to give people an unfiltered, unmediated voice — the opposite of being diluted and silenced — and it grows into something with real, uncontrollable power to destroy a person's reputation overnight, power even its own founder fears and can't fully leash. That's Bruce Banner's arc structurally: the guarded, controlled one builds (releases) something out of his own wound that becomes bigger,

angrier, and more dangerous than he intended. It also lets Film 2 pay off Film 1's ending directly, satisfying the Continuity Bible's 30%-serialized cross-film thread rule (§1) without requiring the audience to have seen Film 1 to follow Film 2's own self-contained story (per the 70% rule).